



through his left hip as well. After spending over nine months in Bombay Hospital and five operations later, Bokade was finally discharged in September 2009. He is still not physically fit to join work and has been advised a hip replacement that will cost him Rs 3 lakh. To add to his woes, Bokade's financial worries are only beginning. So far the family has been surviving on compensation but this will soon run out. Each month, the family's expenditure, including rent, food and nursing fees, adds up to Rs 10,000. However, with only Rs 50,000 of compensation money left in his bank account, Bokade hopes to make this last for as long as possible. His wife, Archana, 27, tending to Bokade and their four-year-old son Raj, has had to leave her job. Now in penury, even she is looking for a job.

When INDIA TODAY approached the Railways, it was told that the RCT Mumbai has 99 cases of compensation of injured and dead of which 18 have been finalised. Once the order copy is sent to the Central Railway, they arrange for the cheques to be distributed. Four cheques of up to Rs 4 lakh have been issued so far, depending upon the seriousness of the case. The rest of the cases are still pending. Bokade applied for an additional claim from the RCT on May 26. He has been told that his case has not been opened yet.

BHUSHAN TANDEL, 25, son of Chandulal Kashinath Tandel, an employee at the A.H. Wheeler book stall at CST, who was shot dead

COMPENSATION DELIVERED: Central Railway (Rs 10 lakh); state Government (Rs 2 Lakh)

COMPENSATION UNDELIVERED: Rs 3 lakh from the Central Government; railway job in the Class D category

Chandulal Tandel was killed by terrorist gunfire at the CST minutes after he spoke to his family for the last time. With Central Government compensation still pending and a railway job for his son nowhere in sight, the children and wife of the deceased railway employee are leading a hand-to-mouth existence. Bhushan's odd jobs as a real estate agent are not enough for their monthly sustenance. Making ends meet with the monthly interest that their compensation amount earns and with sister Sonal's salary of Rs 5,500, the siblings also have to nurse their ailing mother, who has remained inconsolable since the death of her husband. A Union Home Ministry spokesman says: "All cases that have been forwarded to the Home Ministry by the district magistrate have been cleared. Under the scheme, the compensation will be given in a fixed deposit with a three-year lock-in." Also, according to a Central Railway document, Bhushan's job at Western Railway was sanctioned in January 2009 and a letter of appointment has been sent to him; but he has not yet reported for duty. While the Tandels have used the compensation money to repay their home loan, Bhushan denies receiving any letter of appointment.

He is still waiting for it so that he can take the financial burden off his sister's shoulders. "I also have to make sure that my sister gets married and settles down," he says. He hopes to set aside the additional amount of Rs 3 lakh for his sister's wedding preparations and fulfil his father's dream for his sister.

PUSHPALATA, SONAL AND BHUSHAN TANDEL ARE YET TO RECEIVE COMPENSATION FROM THE CENTRAL GOVERNMENT



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